

Detailed Gaia GPS Competitor Roadmap

Created: 2026-06-03

Assumption: 20 hours/week, solo developer, Flutter frontend.

Goal: Build a serious Gaia GPS competitor focused on hiking, overlanding, adventure motorcycling, offline maps, GPX workflows, route planning, and navigation.

Phase 0 – Foundation (40–80h)

Projected dates: 2026-06-03 to 2026-06-30

Study Topics

- GPS fundamentals
- OSM fundamentals
- Routing fundamentals
- GPX format
- Offline maps

Deliverables

- JS GPS viewer
- JS GPX viewer
- Flutter live-location map

Phase 1 – Mapping Core (60–120h)

Projected dates: 2026-07-01 to 2026-08-15

Study Topics

- Flutter mapping architecture
- Mapbox/MapLibre
- Geocoding basics

Deliverables

- Map viewer
- Search
- Markers
- Offline downloads

Phase 2 – Outdoor Navigation Core (100–200h)

Projected dates: 2026-08-16 to 2026-10-15

Study Topics

- Track recording

- Navigation UX
- Elevation concepts

Deliverables

- Track recording
- GPX import/export
- Waypoints
- Off-route alerts

Phase 3 – Routing (80–150h)

Projected dates: 2026-10-16 to 2026-11-30

Study Topics

- GraphHopper or Valhalla
- Routing data
- Route calculation

Deliverables

- A-B routing
- Hiking routing
- Motorcycle routing
- Offline routing

Phase 4 – Offline First (80–150h)

Projected dates: 2026-12-01 to 2027-01-31

Study Topics

- Vector tiles
- MBTiles
- Storage architecture

Deliverables

- Offline search
- Offline navigation
- Regional downloads

Phase 5 – Backend (80–150h)

Projected dates: 2027-02-01 to 2027-03-31

Study Topics

- PostGIS

- Spatial queries
- Sync architecture

Deliverables

- Accounts
- Cloud sync
- Multi-device support

Phase 6 – Integration (150–300h)

Projected dates: 2027-04-01 to 2027-06-30

Study Topics

- Optimization
- Integration
- Hardening

Deliverables

- Combine all MVPs into final application

Final Product Scope

- Offline maps
- Track recording
- Waypoint management
- GPX import/export
- Route planning
- Hiking navigation
- Motorcycle navigation
- Elevation profiles
- Cloud synchronization
- Search

Total Estimated Effort: 600–1150 hours

Aggressive completion: January 2027

Typical completion: April 2027

Full-scope completion: June 2027